DANIEL OKAFOR-REYES

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin and Event-Driven Services

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 7 years of professional experience building and operating Java/Spring Boot services, with additional Kotlin experience and Python scripting experience. Skilled in REST API design, PostgreSQL and relational database query tuning, Kafka event processing, automated testing, CI/CD, Docker, and AWS EKS deployments. Experienced with production on-call and reliability improvements; willing to work mainly in Python while bringing strong comparable-language backend experience.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: Java (8–17), Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, Kotlin (basic), Python scripting

APIs and messaging: REST, OpenAPI 3, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Spring Cloud Contract

Databases and performance: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Redis, JPA query tuning

Cloud and delivery: AWS (EKS, S3, SQS), Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Jenkins, CI/CD

Testing and tools: JUnit 5, Testcontainers, Git, Linux

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech, Lisbon *Jan 2022–Present*

- Develop and maintain seven Java 17 / Spring Boot microservices supporting policy quoting and claims intake.
- Designed and versioned an OpenAPI 3 REST API for partner quoting; onboarded 12 broker partners handling approximately 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Added partner-specific rate limiting and contract tests using Spring Cloud Contract.
- Improved quote endpoint p99 latency from 1.8 seconds to 450 milliseconds by adding Redis caching and resolving JPA N+1 queries.
- Resolved duplicate claim records caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing a transactional outbox and idempotent consumers; duplicate records fell from approximately 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Deploy Java/Spring Boot services to Kubernetes on AWS EKS using Helm charts and Jenkins CI/CD pipelines; participate in a one-week-per-month on-call rota.
- Handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024 and contributed a post-incident write-up that was praised by the team.
- Built a small internal Kotlin / Spring Boot service to render policy PDFs from templates using AWS S3 and SQS, and wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.
- Run a fortnightly backend guild since 2024, facilitating technical knowledge-sharing.
- Use Python for data-fix scripts and small Jenkins helper scripts; have not shipped a Python service.

Software Developer | Viajar Online S.A., Porto *Sep 2019–Dec 2021*

- Built booking and payment features in a Java 11 / Spring MVC monolith backed by Oracle.
- Wrote integration tests with Testcontainers, increasing payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70% and supporting safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a Spring Boot service using RabbitMQ and Thymeleaf.

Junior Developer (Internship, then Full-Time) | CodeFarol Lda, Porto *Jul 2018–Aug 2019*

- Maintained PHP and later Java applications for small business clients.

EDUCATION

BSc Informatics Engineering | Atlantic Polytechnic Institute, 2018

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer, 2020

LANGUAGES

English (fluent; professional working language at Tejo Insurance Tech)
Portuguese (fluent)
Spanish (conversational)